

● HARD

● PROBLEM-SOLVING AND DATA ANALYSIS

● ANSWER KEY

Problem-Solving and Data Analysis

06

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**.88**

Accept also: 22/25

The correct answer is .88 . It's given that the number a is 60% greater than the positive number b . Therefore, $a = 1 + \frac{60}{100}b$, which is equivalent to $a = 1 + 0.60b$, or $a = 1.60b$. It's also given that the number c is 45% less than a . Therefore, $c = 1 - \frac{45}{100}a$, which is equivalent to $c = 1 - 0.45a$, or $c = 0.55a$. Since $a = 1.60b$, substituting $1.60b$ for a in the equation $c = 0.55a$ yields $c = 0.55(1.60b)$, or $c = 0.88b$. Thus, the number c is 0.88 times the number b . Note that .88 and 22/25 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Q2**C****C. 32**

Choice C is correct. If the mean score of 8 players is 14.5, then the total of all 8 scores is $14.5 \times 8 = 116$. If the mean of 7 scores is 12, then the total of all 7 scores is $12 \times 7 = 84$. Since the set of 7 scores was made by removing the highest score of the set of 8 scores, then the difference between the total of all 8 scores and the total of all 7 scores is equal to the removed score: $116 - 84 = 32$.

Choice A is incorrect because if 20 is removed from the group of 8 scores, then the mean score of the remaining 7 players is $\frac{(14.5 \times 8) - 20}{7}$ is approximately 13.71, not 12. Choice B is incorrect because if 24 is removed from the group of 8 scores, then the mean score of the remaining 7 players is $\frac{(14.5 \times 8) - 24}{7}$ is approximately 13.14, not 12. Choice D is incorrect because if 36 is removed from the group of 8 scores, then the mean score of the remaining 7 players is $\frac{(14.5 \times 8) - 36}{7}$ or approximately 11.43, not 12.

Q3

B

B. $3y$

Choice B is correct. It's given that object R travels a distance of $4x$ inches in y seconds. This speed can be written as $\frac{4x \text{ inches}}{y \text{ seconds}}$. It's given that the speed of object R is half the speed of object S. It follows that the speed of object S is twice the speed of object R, which is $2\frac{4x \text{ inches}}{y \text{ seconds}}$, or $\frac{8x \text{ inches}}{y \text{ seconds}}$. Let n represent the time, in seconds, it takes object S to travel a distance of $24x$ inches. The value of n can be found by solving the equation $\frac{8x \text{ inches}}{y \text{ seconds}} = \frac{24x \text{ inches}}{n \text{ seconds}}$, which can be written as $\frac{8x}{y} = \frac{24x}{n}$. Multiplying each side of this equation by ny yields $8xn = 24xy$. Dividing each side of this equation by $8x$ yields $n = 3y$. Therefore, the expression $3y$ represents the time, in seconds, it takes object S to travel a distance of $24x$ inches.

Choice A is incorrect. This expression represents the time, in seconds, it would take object S to travel a distance of $24x$ inches if the speed of object R were twice, not half, the speed of object S.

Choice C is incorrect. This expression represents the time, in seconds, it takes object S to travel a distance of $128x$ inches, not $24x$ inches.

Choice D is incorrect. This expression represents the time, in seconds, it takes object R, not object S, to travel a distance of $24x$ inches.

Q4**A**

A. Account A always earns more money per year than Account B.

Choice A is correct. Account A starts with \$500 and earns interest at 6% per year, so in the first year Account A earns $(500)(0.06) = \$30$, which is greater than the \$25 that Account B earns that year. Compounding interest can be modeled by an increasing exponential function, so each year Account A will earn more money than it did the previous year. Therefore, each year Account A earns at least \$30 in interest. Since Account B always earns \$25 each year, Account A always earns more money per year than Account B.

Choices B and D are incorrect. Account A earns \$30 in the first year, which is greater than the \$25 Account B earns in the first year. Therefore, neither the statement that Account A always earns less money per year than Account B nor the statement that Account A earns less money than Account B at first can be true. Choice C is incorrect. Since compounding interest can be modeled by an increasing exponential function, each year Account A will earn more money than it did the previous year. Therefore, Account A always earns at least \$30 per year, which is more than the \$25 per year that Account B earns.

Q5**8**

The correct answer is 8. The 6 students represent $(100 - 15 - 45 - 25)\% = 15\%$ of those invited to join the committee. If x people were invited to join the committee, then $0.15x = 6$. Thus, there were $\frac{6}{0.15} = 40$ people invited to join the committee. It follows that there were $0.45(40) = 18$ teachers and $0.25(40) = 10$ school and district administrators invited to join the committee. Therefore, there were 8 more teachers than school and district administrators invited to join the committee.

Q6

B

- B. The mean of the new data set is greater than the mean of the original data set, and the medians of the two data sets are equal.
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Choice B is correct. The mean of a data set is the sum of the values in the data set divided by the number of values in the data set. The new data set consists of the weights of the 71 tortoises in the original data set and one additional weight, 39. Since the additional weight, 39, is greater than any of the values in the original data set, the mean of the new data set is greater than the mean of the original data set. If a data set contains an odd number of data values, the median is represented by the middle data value in the list when the data values are listed in ascending or descending order. Since the original data set consists of the weights of 71 tortoises and is in ascending order, the median of the original data set is represented by the middle value, or the 36th value. Based on the frequencies shown in the table, the 36th value in this data set is 17. If a data set contains an even number of data values, the median is between the two middle data values when the values are listed in ascending or descending order. Since the new data set consists of the weights of 72 tortoises, the median of the new data set is between the 36th and 37th data values when the values are arranged in ascending order. To keep the data in ascending order, the additional value of 39 would be placed at the bottom of the frequency table with a frequency of 1. Therefore, based on the frequencies in the table, the 36th and 37th values in the new data set are both 17. It follows that the median of the new data set is 17, which is the same as the median of the original data set. Therefore, the mean of the new data set is greater than the mean of the original data set, and the medians of the two data sets are equal.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q7**B****B.** 3.83

Choice B is correct. Since 1 mile is equal to 1,760 yards, 1 square mile is equal to $1,760^2$, or 3,097,600, square yards. It's given that the park has an area of 11,863,808 square yards.

Therefore, the park has an area of 11,863,808 square yards $\frac{1 \text{ square mile}}{3,097,600 \text{ square yards}}$, or $\frac{11,863,808}{3,097,600}$ square miles. Thus, the area, in square miles, of the park is 3.83.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect. This is the square root of the area of the park in square yards, not the area of the park in square miles.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from converting 11,863,808 yards to miles, rather than converting 11,863,808 square yards to square miles.

Q8**4.5**

Accept also: 9/2

The correct answer is $\frac{9}{2}$. It's given that the scatterplot shows the relationship between the length of time y , in hours, a certain bird spent in flight and the number of days after January 11, x . Since January 13 is 2 days after January 11, it follows that January 13 corresponds to an x -value of 2 in the scatterplot. In the scatterplot, when $x = 2$, the corresponding value of y is 6. In other words, on January 13, the bird spent 6 hours in flight. Since January 15 is 4 days after January 11, it follows that January 15 corresponds to an x -value of 4 in the scatterplot. In the scatterplot, when $x = 4$, the corresponding value of y is 15. In other words, on January 15, the bird spent 15 hours in flight. Therefore, the average rate of change, in hours per day, of the length of time the bird spent in flight on January 13 to the length of time the bird spent in flight on January 15 is the difference in the length of time, in hours, the bird spent in flight divided by the difference in the number of days after January 11, or $\frac{15-6}{4-2}$, which is equivalent to $\frac{9}{2}$. Note that 9/2 and 4.5 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Q9**.54**

Accept also: 27/50

The correct answer is .54 . It's given that the number a is 70% less than the positive number b . Therefore, $a = 1 - \frac{70}{100}b$, which is equivalent to $a = 1 - 0.70b$, or $a = 0.30b$. It's also given that the number c is 80% greater than a . Therefore, $c = 1 + \frac{80}{100}a$, which is equivalent to $c = 1 + 0.80a$, or $c = 1.80a$. Since $a = 0.30b$, substituting $0.30b$ for a in the equation $c = 1.80a$ yields $c = 1.80(0.30b)$, or $c = 0.54b$. Thus, c is 0.54 times b . Note that .54 and 27/50 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Q10**A****A. I only**

Choice A is correct. The median of a data set with an odd number of values that are in ascending or descending order is the middle value of the data set. Since the distribution of the values of both data set A and data set B form symmetric dot plots, and each data set has an odd number of values, it follows that the median is given by the middle value in each of the dot plots. Thus, the median of data set A is 13, and the median of data set B is 13. Therefore, statement I is true. Data set A and data set B have the same frequency for each of the values 11, 12, 14, and 15. Data set A has a frequency of 1 for values 10 and 16, whereas data set B has a frequency of 2 for values 10 and 16. Standard deviation is a measure of the spread of a data set; it is larger when there are more values further from the mean, and smaller when there are more values closer to the mean. Since both distributions are symmetric with an odd number of values, the mean of each data set is equal to its median. Thus, each data set has a mean of 13. Since more of the values in data set A are closer to 13 than data set B, it follows that data set A has a smaller standard deviation than data set B. Thus, statement II is false. Therefore, only statement I must be true.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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